Mekkala Mobile Launches TideLine Fleet Plan for Small Fishing Boats

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SONGKHLA, 28 September 2026 – Mekkala Telecom Public Company Limited (Mekkala Mobile) today announced the TideLine Fleet Plan, a mobile service designed for small-scale fishing boats working along the lower Gulf coast between Pattani and Nakhon Si Thammarat. The plan goes on sale on 15 October 2026 and uses nine new high-mast coastal sites that extend usable voice and data coverage to about 40 kilometres offshore in normal weather. Before these sites were switched on, Mekkala's coverage along this coast ended about 12 kilometres from shore, while most family boats fish 15 to 35 kilometres out.

"Fishing families asked for a way to call for help, early storm warnings and a simple way to say they are safe. TideLine puts all three on an ordinary phone," said Phanida Thongsuk, Head of Coastal Networks at Mekkala Mobile.

1. What the TideLine Fleet Plan includes

- **Monthly price:** 199 baht per boat, including VAT. This covers the captain's main SIM. During the pilot the price was 149 baht; the pilot price ends on 14 October 2026 and all pilot boats move to the standard price from the November 2026 bill.
- **Data and calls:** 20 GB of mobile data per month, unlimited calls between phones registered on TideLine plans, and 100 minutes per month to other Thai mobile and landline numbers.
- **SeaCall distress code *4848:** dialling *4848 connects directly to the Mekkala Maritime Watch Room in Hat Yai, which is staffed 24 hours a day. The call is free and works even when the SIM has no remaining balance. Its staff pass the boat's last known position to coast rescue volunteers.
- **Storm alerts:** warning SMS messages are sent in Thai, English and Burmese whenever forecast wind for the boat's registered fishing zone reaches Beaufort force 6 or higher.
- **Safe check-in:** the captain sends the word POS by SMS to 4848. If a boat that has started a trip sends no check-in for 12 hours, the Watch Room calls the boat first and then the registered shore contact.

2. Coverage area

The nine new sites stand at Sai Buri (Pattani), Thepha, Chana, Singhanakhon, Sathing Phra and Ranot (Songkhla), and Hua Sai, Pak Phanang and Sichon (Nakhon Si Thammarat). Coverage at 40 kilometres requires the external boat antenna described in section 4; a handset used on deck without it normally keeps a signal to about 25 kilometres.

Note. Coverage around Ko Kra and in the open water east of it is not part of the TideLine service area. Boats fishing there should continue to carry radio equipment. SeaCall *4848 still works wherever any Mekkala signal is available.

Fictional document created for testing a question-answering system. All names, figures and organisations are invented.

3. Who can join

The plan is open to boats under 30 gross tons that hold a valid provincial fishing licence and are based at a pier in Pattani, Songkhla or Nakhon Si Thammarat. The boat owner must be resident in Thailand and register the plan in his or her own name. Trawlers of 30 gross tons and above use Mekkala's business fleet contracts instead.

Each boat can add up to five crew SIMs in addition to the captain's main SIM, so a boat can have at most six TideLine SIMs. Each crew SIM costs 99 baht per month and receives 5 GB of data, unlimited calls to other TideLine phones, and the same SeaCall and storm alert services as the main SIM. Crew members who are not Thai nationals can receive a crew SIM by showing a valid passport or work permit.

4. How to register

1. The boat owner brings the boat registration book, the fishing licence and his or her ID card to any Mekkala shop in the three provinces, or to the TideLine service van, which visits the main fishing piers every Saturday from 08:00 to 14:00.
2. The owner names one shore contact, whose phone number must not belong to anyone who sails on the same boat.
3. The owner chooses the boat's fishing zone on a printed map, so storm alerts match the area where the boat actually works. The zone can be changed later at a shop or through the Maritime Services Desk.
4. A Mekkala technician fits the external boat antenna at the pier. The antenna normally costs 1,200 baht but is fitted free for boats registered by 31 December 2026.
5. Before the boat leaves the pier, the captain makes a test call to *4848 and the Watch Room confirms the boat's name and shore contact. The plan is active within 24 hours of a successful test call.

5. Results of the Chana pilot

From 2 March to 31 August 2026, 214 boats from Chana and Thepha tested the service. The Watch Room handled 3 genuine distress calls, alerting rescue volunteers in an average of 7 minutes. Storm alerts reached 96 per cent of registered phones before crews left the pier.

6. Support and responsibilities

Network building and the coastal site programme are led by Phanida Thongsuk, Head of Coastal Networks. Day-to-day customer matters for the plan, including registration problems, missing storm alerts, changes to the shore contact and complaints about coverage at sea, are handled by the Maritime Services Desk, managed by Ekachai Boonma. The desk can be reached on 0 7430 4848 from 07:00 to 21:00 every day, or through the "TideLine" menu in the Mekkala app. Emergencies at sea must always go to SeaCall *4848, not to the desk number.

About Mekkala Mobile. Mekkala Telecom Public Company Limited was founded in 2009 and has its head office in Hat Yai, Songkhla. It serves about 3.1 million mobile customers in southern Thailand.

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